villi the nutritive portions of the food are absorbed by a set of vessels called lacteals, but not until the chyme, or half-digested food, has been further prepared by a juice, secreted by a long gland situated on the right side of the stomach, called the pancreas. This gland pours out a fluid called the pancreatic juice, and its peculiar property seems to be to mix with and prepare the fatty matters taken into the system for general distribution.

The final act of the digestive process is performed by the liver. This is a large gland, divided into several lobes, pierced thickly with blood-vessels, and having a circulation of its own, called the portal circulation.

One of the chief offices of the liver is to secrete or manufacture a bitter, acrid fluid, called bile. This is poured out into a small duct, adhering to the lower side of the liver, called the gall-bladder. There is a duct which leads direct from the liver into the gall-bladder, and from this again into the small intestine, at or about the same point as the pancreatic duct, and this is called the bile-duct. Through this passage the biliary fluid is poured in a given quantity into the small intestine, changing so materially the character of the chyme, that after it has passed beyond the pancreatic and bile ducts it is converted into a white, milk-like fluid; in fact, it now assumes that rudimental condition of which blood is formed, and, having undergone its last change in the act of digestion, it is called chyle, and is taken up as already stated by absorption through the mucous membrane of the small intestine into a set of vessels termed